

5. Choose the 'update from zip file' option and select the firmware file that you had earlier copied into the SD card.

Some phones (like HTC's newer devices) come with locked bootloaders that prevent you from installing a third-party firmware. There are tools available (HTC provides an official tool to unlock the bootloader) to circumvent this issue, though the process may not always be straightforward. Find out if your phone comes with any such restrictions before you begin the flashing process. If you're running a rooted Android device, make sure you take a complete backup of your ROM using Clockworkmod's Backup and Restore feature. Furthermore, developers usually make a list of all the fully working features as well as bugs in the build, read it and make sure that the ROM is stable enough for everyday use.

Android is truly a hacker's dream, for it provides almost endless potential to tweak and mod your device to your heart's content. You can improve existing features, add new ones or remove ones you don't need, and truly customize your mobile experience provided you know what you're getting into. Having said that, hacking into one's Android device is not a necessity – Android is a highly advanced platform with plenty of features right out of the box, along with a plethora of apps to try out from the Google Play Store. However if you're someone who's not content with 'good-enough' and is looking to extend your phone's functionality, Android should be your platform of choice. 



Clockworkmod is a powerful recovery image for your phone